Julianna J. Thomson

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Education

George Mason University Expected May 2027
Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science
Comprehensive Exams: American Government, International Relations
Committee: Mark J. Rozell (Chair), Robert J. McGrath, Kendrick Kuo, James P. Pfiffner
Dissertation: Sacred Speech in a Secularizing Society: Three Papers on Religious Rhetoric

Villanova University 2022
M.B.A., Strategic Management
Varsity Track & Field

Dartmouth College 2020
A.B., Religion
Exchange Program: New College School of Theology, University of Edinburgh
Varsity Basketball and Track & Field

Additional Training

The Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR), Syracuse University 2025
Graduate Teaching Academy, Stearns Center for Teaching and Learning, George Mason University 2025
Graduate Student Workshop, Association for the Study of Religion, Economics, and Culture 2023

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

2. **Thomson, Julianna J.**, and Mark J. Rozell. 2025. "Challenges to Protecting Religious Freedoms: The Roles of Government and Societal Norms." *Ethos. Quarterly of the John Paul II Catholic University of Lublin.* 38(3):155-73. https://doi.org/10.12887/38-2025-3-151-10.

1. **Thomson, Julianna J.**, and Alena Smith. 2025. "Sacred Speech: Analyzing the Influence of Congressional Leadership on Religious Rhetoric." *Politics and Religion.* 18(3):383-407. https://doi.org/10.1017/S1755048325100102.

    - Awarded the Society for the Scientific Study of Religion 2025 Student Paper Award for the best student paper published in 2025.

Book Chapters

1. Carty, Thomas J., and **Julianna J. Thomson**. 2025. "Catholic Senators and Abortion Politics: The Cases of Joe Biden and Ted Kennedy." In *Religion and Congress: The Intersection of Faith and Politics*, edited by David A. Dulio and Colton C. Campbell, 97–114. Boulder, Colorado: Lynne Rienner Publishers, Inc.

    - Book reviewed here: https://doi.org/10.1017/S1537592726104551

Public Scholarship

2. Smith, Alena, and **Julianna J. Thomson**. 2025. "The 2026 Midterms: Speaker Mike Johnson's Religious Rhetoric Will Continue to Shape How Republicans Speak to Their Constituents." London School of Economics United States Centre (blog). https://blogs.lse.ac.uk/usappblog/2025/07/30/the-2026-midterms-speaker-mike-johnsons-religious-rhetoric-will-continue-to-shape-how-republicans-speak-to-their-constituents/.

1. Smith, Alena, and **Julianna J. Thomson.** 2025. "The Johnson Effect: How the New Speaker Sparked a Religious Rhetoric Surge." Religion in Public (blog). https://religioninpublic.blog/2025/07/14/the-johnson-effect-how-the-new-speaker-sparked-a-religious-rhetoric-surge/.

Research in Progress

Under Review:
"Youth Sports, Gender, and Pathways to Political Involvement" with Amanda Friesen (Western University), Noah Vanderhoeven (Western University), and Lachlan Fisher (Western University) - *Under review at the British Journal of Political Science.*

"Measuring Christian Nationalist Rhetoric in Congress: Evidence from Legislator E-Newsletters" with Cammie Jo Bolin (University at Albany) and Alena Smith (Stanford University) - *Under review at Political Studies Review (abstract accepted for special issue, "250th Anniversary of the United States of America's Founding: America at a Turning Point?").*

"Gender and Political Ambition: Evidence from NCAA Student-Athletes" with Cammie Jo Bolin (University at Albany) - *Under review at Political Behavior.*

In Progress:
The Christian Right: What Everyone Needs to Know with Mark J. Rozell (George Mason University) and Clyde Wilcox (Georgetown University) - *Under contract with Oxford University Press.*

"Homestyle homilies? How Legislator and District Religiosity Shape Congressional Communication" with Cammie Jo Bolin (University at Albany) - *Working paper.*

"Religion and War Termination" with Stephen Gailliot (George Mason University) - *Working paper.*

"How Proximity to National Parks Shapes Voting Behavior: Evidence from U.S. Counties, 2000-2024" with Stephen Gailliot (George Mason University) - *Working paper.*

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record
"Religion and the American Presidency," Encore Learning — Fall 2024

Research and Work Experience

Graduate Research Assistant, Schar School of Policy and Government — 2022-2027
Research Assistant to Dr. Mark J. Rozell, Dean of the Schar School of Policy and Government

NCAA Division 1 Varsity Track & Field Coach
Villanova University — 2024-2026
George Mason University — 2023-2024

Business Research Fellow, Villanova School of Business — 2020-2022
Research Assistant to Dr. Jonathan Doh, Senior Associate Dean for Research
Research Assistant to Dr. Denise Downey, KPMG Endowed Professor in Accounting

Senior Admissions Fellow, Dartmouth College — 2019-2020
Research Intern, Council for Advancement and Support of Education — 2018

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

George Mason University
Presidential Scholarship (full tuition and stipend) — 2022–2026
Daniel Druckman Fellowship ($8000) — 2025
Schar School IQMR Grant ($3025) — 2025
May La Due Bishop Book Fund ($1200) — 2024
Schar School Conference Travel Grant (total $5000) — 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026

Villanova University
Graduate Research Fellowship (full tuition and stiped) — 2020–2022

Dartmouth College

Religion Department Faculty Prize ($750)	2020
Citation for Meritorious Performance	2019

External

APSA Political Communication Section Conference Travel Award ($600)	2026
APSA Graduate Student Support Grant ($150)	2025
Society for the Scientific Study of Religion Student Paper Award ($500)	2025
ASREC Graduate Student Workshop Grant ($800)	2023
All-Academic First Team, Big East Conference	2021, 2022

Conference Attendance and Presentations

11. Keeping the Republic Conference hosted by the Rooney Democracy Initiative at the University of Notre Dame, South Bend, IN. May 2027. *By invitiation (Scheduled).*

10. Religion and Democracy: New Empirical Methods Conference hosted by the Religion and Democracy Lab at the University of Notre Dame, South Bend, IN. May 2027. *By invitiation (Scheduled).*

9. "Civic Engagement and Gendered Leadership among NCAA Student-Athletes." American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Boston, MA. September 2026. *Paper presentation with Cammie Jo Bolin (Virtual).*

8. "Christian Nationalism in Congressional Communication in the Twenty-First Century." Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference, Chicago, IL. April 2026. *Paper presentation with Cammie Jo Bolin and Alena Smith.*

7. "Presidential Religious Rhetoric and War." 2025 West Point Social Sciences Seminar, West Point, NY. February 2025. *Paper presentation.*

    - Coverage: https://press.westpoint.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/5/2026/02/SOSH-2025-Layout_JMF4.pdf#page=53

6. "Leathernecks and Lexicon: Exploring Partisanship in the US Military." The Inter-University Seminar on Armed Forces and Society Canada Conference, Ottawa, Canada. October 2024. *Paper presentation (Virtual).*

5. "Sacred Speech: Analyzing the Influence of Congressional Leadership on Religious Rhetoric." Society for the Scientific Study of Religion Annual Meeting, Pittsburgh, PA. October 2024. *Paper presentation.*

4. "From Silence to Speech: Women's Participation in Christian Nationalism." American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA. September 2024. *Paper presentation.*

3. "Leathernecks and Lexicon: Exploring Partisanship in the US Military." American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA. September 2024. *Paper presentation.*

2. "Leathernecks and Lexicon: Exploring Partisanship in the US Military." US Army War College Civil-Military Relations Center Annual Conference, Carlisle, PA. May 2024. *Paper presentation with Ryan Pallas.*

1. "Faithful Leadership: Analyzing the Influence of Speaker Mike Johnson's Religious Identity in the House." Henry Institute Symposium on Religion and Public Life, Grand Rapids, MI. April 2024. *Paper presentation.*

Service and Leadership

To the Discipline

International Officer, Religion and Politics Specialist Group, Political Studies Association	2025-Present
Co-Organizer: Religion and Politics Working Group, MPSA Annual Meeting	2026
Panel Chair: West Point Social Sciences Seminar	2025
Henry Symposium on Religion and Public Life	2024
Discussant: Henry Symposium on Religion and Public Life	2024
Reviewer: *Politics and Religion*	Ongoing

To the Institution

Leadership Team, Schar PhD Student Association, George Mason University	2025-2026
Consultant, Writing Support Lab, George Mason University	2024-2026
Treasurer, Schar PhD Student Association, George Mason University	2024-2025
Alumni Admissions Interviewer, Dartmouth College	2020-Present

Professional Memberships

Canadian Political Science Association	2025-Present
Political Studies Association	2025-Present
Society for the Scientific Study of Religion	2024-Present
American Political Science Association	2023-Present

Skills

Computing: R, R Markdown, LaTeX, Qualtrics, Microsoft Suite